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hinges and CPU fan.

As far as the battery is concerned, it is the decapacitisation that requires the batteries to be replaced every three-four years.

Some of the most common mistakes that contribute towards reducing a notebook's life are charging the notebook from a socket without proper earthing and using water instead of a plain soft cloth to wipe the notebook.

Also, many consumers use their notebook by keeping it on soft surfaces which impede air circulation inside the notebook, leading to heating up of the components and hence reduction in their average life.

Best practices to enhance the life

Notebooks, like any other consumer product, need the regular weekly dust-away treatment, especially on the

keyboards and the screen. Accumulation of dust particles over a period of time on the notebook's vents and fans can affect the ventilation and hence cause over-heating. This, in turn, can affect the performance of the system.

The display is not glass. So it's advisable to use a microfibre (lint-free) cloth to remove dust from the LCD in power-off mode. Take care not to touch or apply pressure on the screen while doing so. Also, never use a chemical to clean the screen.

While travelling, carry the notebook in a proper cushioned bag to avoid damage that happens due to man-handling and also shock impacts. Also, don't expose the notebook to direct sunlight and extreme conditions. Keeping the notebook away from hot and humid places will help prevent corrosion of crucial parts.

It is absolutely imperative to have the latest anti-virus software installed to avoid slow working of the notebook and damages to the system. Installing only legitimate software instead of counterfeits also helps to reduce crashes and bugs on the operating system.

Coming to batteries, ensure that the notebook's battery is not overheated or overcooled in an area. The battery is made of chemicals inside the cell. Temperature plays a big role in the way the cells create power in the notebook. If the battery gets overheated, its lifespan and capacity will reduce. That is why it is important never to overcharge the battery as well.

Use a compatible adaptor to charge the battery of the notebook. Let the battery discharge fully and recharge instead of intermittent charges.

It is also not advisable to keep the notebook plugged on for extended periods of time. Not only does it overheat the system, it also reduces the battery's performance. For long-hours use, it is advisable to run the notebook on electricity—sometimes with the battery out of the socket.

It is recommended to replace the



Microsoft notebook cooling pad

battery of the notebook after a period of two years with a new battery to ensure optimal performance. Besides, an upgrade for RAM and other components could also give a boost to the performance of the notebook.

When the notebook is in use, optimising the display setting (colour and brightness) suitably helps to extend the battery life.

Ensure that the notebook is serviced at least once every six months. The hard disk needs regular checkups and 'clean-disk' runs.

In short, keeping the notebook clean, handling it with care and running the maintenance software all add to the life of the notebook.

Accessories that could help

There are many accessories available in the market that could help in extending the life of a notebook.

There are well-cushioned laptop cases/bags and cooling pads having cooling fans that keep the temperature of the notebook in control while in use. Accessories like cleaning kits that are designed according to the requirements of notebooks, vacuum cleaners to remove dust, screen guards and transparent keyboard guards will help you to keep the physical parts of the notebook clean and dust-free.

Besides, an anti-surge protector or spike guard would help to ensure lesser fluctuation and therefore longer life. ●

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